

THE UNICODE BENEATH THE WORLD



JULY 26, 2026

I induced lucidity through sleep paralysis, but I lost it almost as soon as the dream began.



I found myself attending a strange academy governed by a king who was also my father.



Inside that reality, obedience felt built into my role. I served him because he was both my parent and my ruler.



His aloof wife carried herself like a queen, and the two of them regularly gave me tasks.



Even when I did not want to help, I usually did what they asked out of respect for my father's authority.





Our class assignment was to build a device that could fly by using magnetic coils.

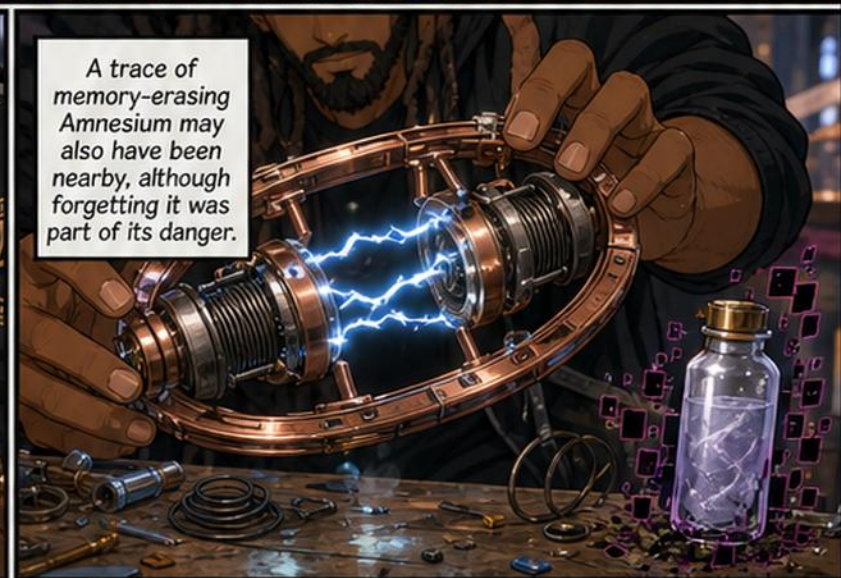
The instructors blended familiar faces, including a cool, dapper art teacher with blue eyes and a curled mustache.



The classroom was rowdy, but I refused to let anyone pull my attention away from the project.



I shaped rainbow-colored Morphium around spring-loaded coils, using an old dream substance to support a new machine.



A trace of memory-erasing Amnesia may also have been nearby, although forgetting it was part of its danger.

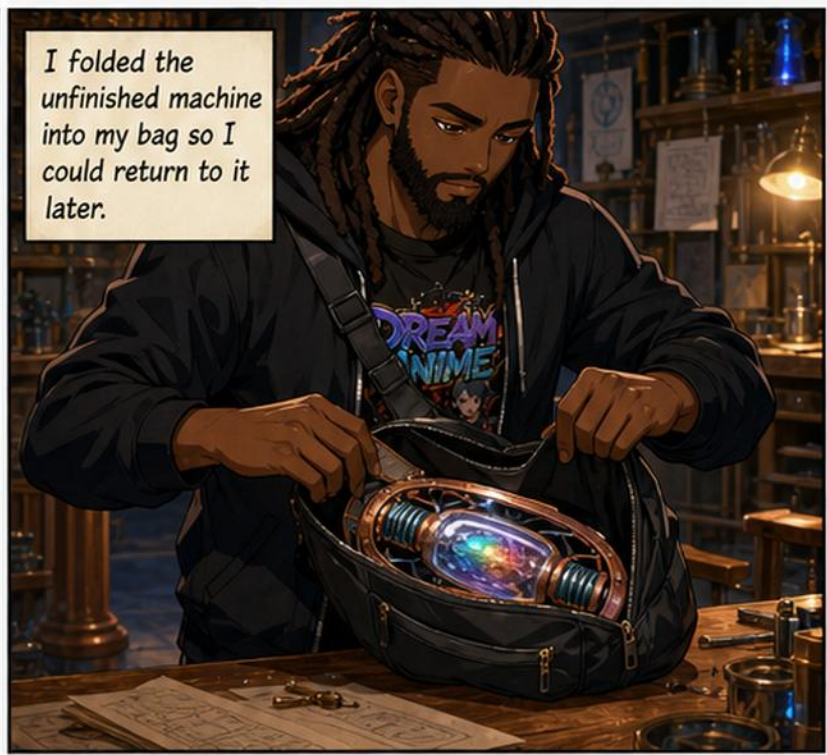


The machine nearly lifted itself into stable flight. I could feel that the underlying idea was sound.

The device never fully worked, but I did not dismantle it or treat the attempt as a permanent failure.



I folded the unfinished machine into my bag so I could return to it later.



Then I completed another request for my father and his wife and gave them exactly what they wanted.



Once they received it, they showed no interest in me or in the effort I had made.



They simply fell asleep, leaving me without acknowledgment, feedback, or any meaningful reaction.



Their indifference disappointed me, and when school ended I began searching for another way out.



Leaving the academy did not feel permitted, so I slipped through a rear exit and sneaked past security.



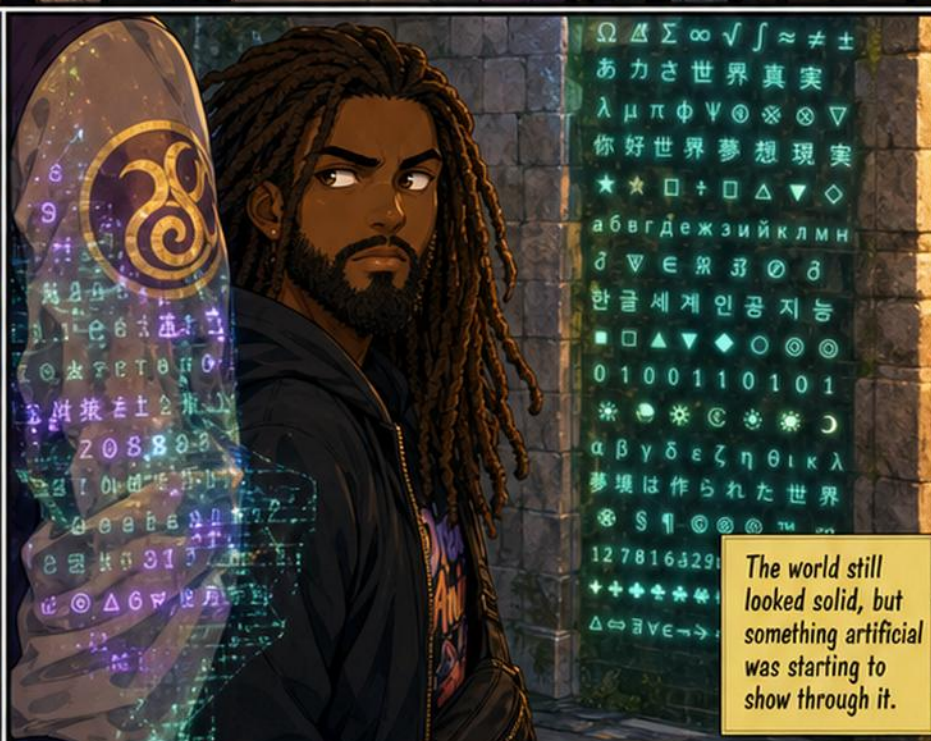
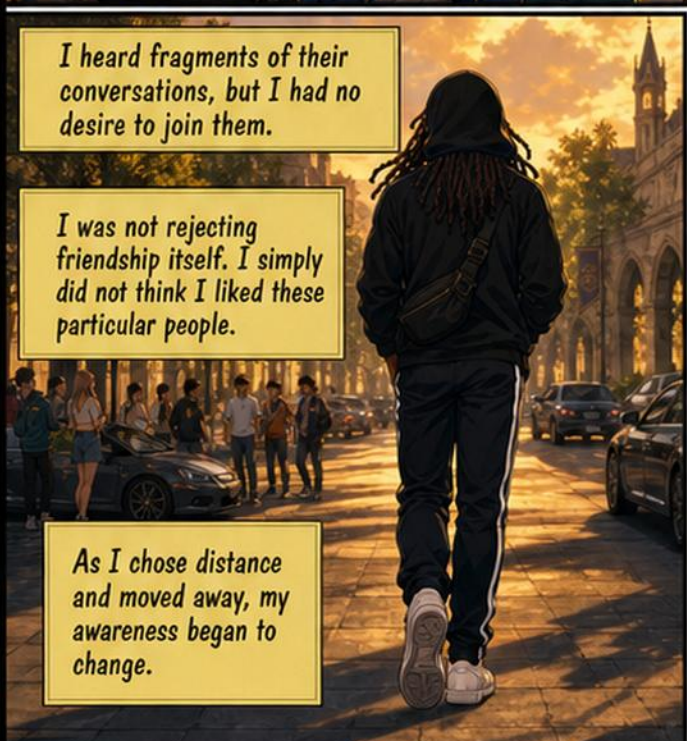
Outside, the rowdy students from class gathered in a pickup lane and talked while waiting for rides.



I heard fragments of their conversations, but I had no desire to join them.

I was not rejecting friendship itself. I simply did not think I liked these particular people.

As I chose distance and moved away, my awareness began to change.



The world still looked solid, but something artificial was starting to show through it.

I did not clearly announce that I was dreaming, and I did not summon my usual Lucid Light.



Instead, I became certain that the objects and people around me were not made from ordinary matter.



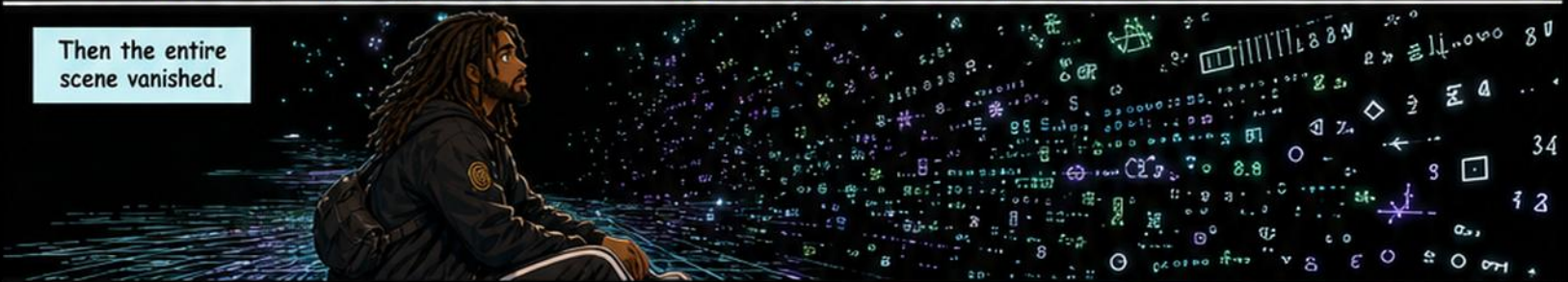
Characters and symbols began bleeding through every visible surface.



The students, the pickup area, and the academy dissolved into streams of encoded information.

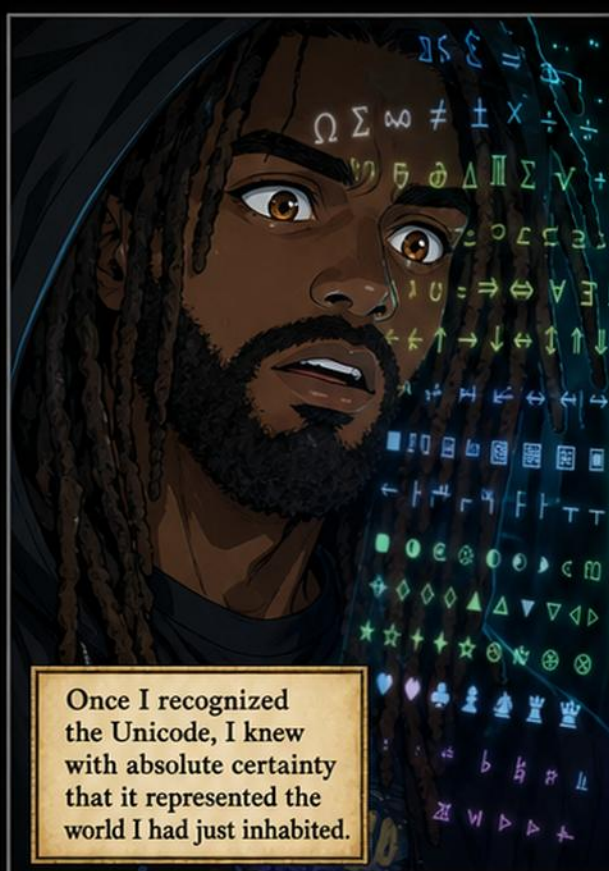


Then the entire scene vanished.

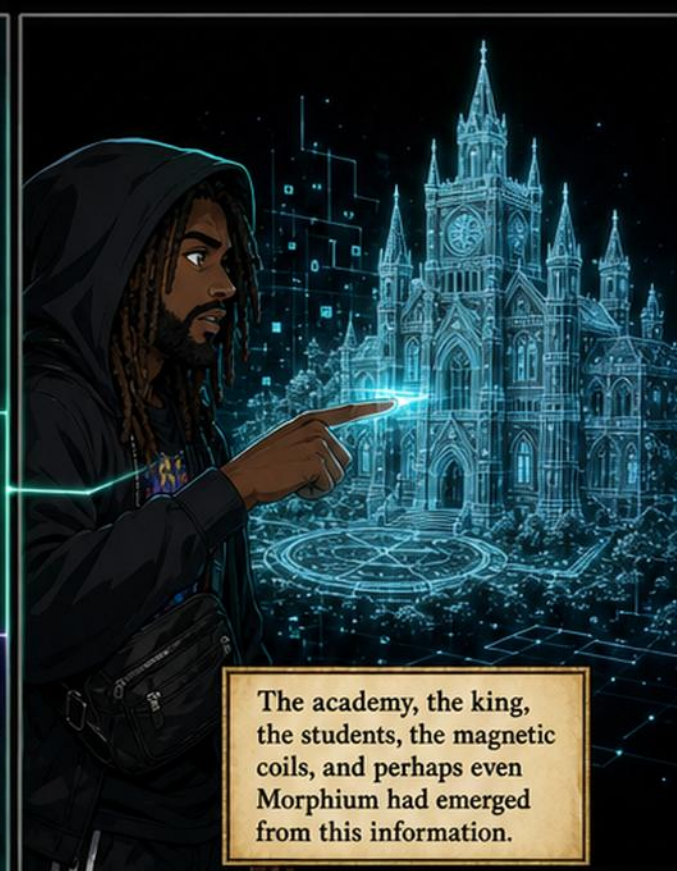


I was seated before a terminal, staring at a screen filled completely with Unicode.





Once I recognized the Unicode, I knew with absolute certainty that it represented the world I had just inhabited.



The academy, the king, the students, the magnetic coils, and perhaps even Morphium had emerged from this information.



The text was not static. It described motion, transformation, behavior, and continuous change.



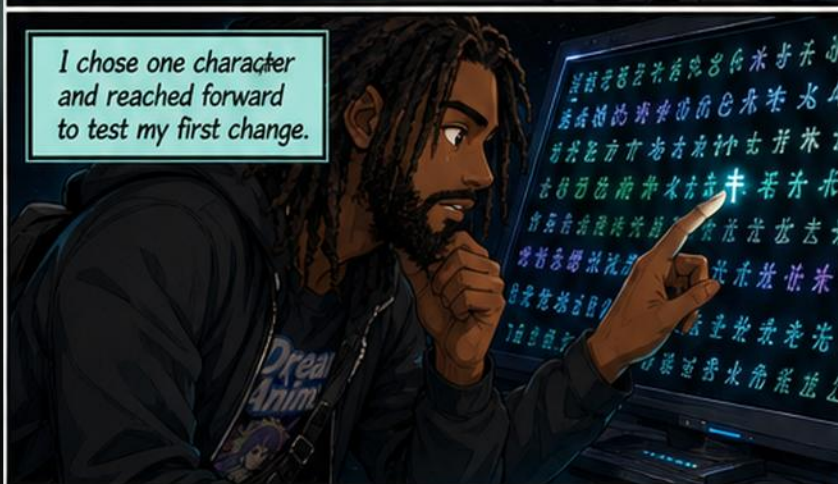
I had reached the hidden controls beneath the dream, but I still could not decipher how each character mapped to reality.

Awareness had given me access to the source. Understanding it would be the next step.

A deeper form of lucidity seemed possible: I might rewrite the dream directly instead of reshaping it with Lucid Light.



Like my almost-flying machine, the interface was unfinished knowledge rather than a disproven idea.



I chose one character and reached forward to test my first change.



For one instant, the world-outline responded beneath my hand.



Before I could move the symbol or learn what it controlled, my alarm went off.



I awoke knowing I had reached the foundation of the dream—only one moment too early to rewrite it.